

Benard W. Kihuria

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EDUCATION

University of Maryland

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Computational Finance [GPA: 3.5]

College Park, MD

Expected May 2026

Awards/Honors: Academic Honors, UMD Scholar, Recipient of the Tilghman Scholarship

Relevant Courses: Advanced DS and Algorithms in Java, Computer Programming in C and Assembly, Introduction to Functional Programming, Introduction to Data Science, Algorithms, Discrete Structures, Applied Probability and Statistics, Linear Algebra

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: C, OCaml, Python, Java, React, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Rust, MIPS Assembly, SQL, Bash

Software: Linux, Git, Figma, Eclipse, Postman, Pandas, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NumPy, Matplotlib, SciPy, Seaborn

Certifications: CodePath Certificate in Advanced Technical Interview Prep

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Arch Linux Configuration (Linux, Bash, Python, Lua, Git)

- Built an Arch Linux configuration starting from a minimal installation, successfully integrating the i3 window manager and X11 display server
- Installed applications such as Neovim and Picom enhanced by personalized configuration via the manipulation of corresponding .config files
- Created personalized scripts such as multi-monitor rendering, navigation system handling, quick menu protocols, and many more
- Utilized various APIs to showcase relevant updated information on my screen, for example unread emails, weather, and Spotify information
- Diagnosed window manager overrides, systemd complexities, Google API discrepancies, tty startup protocols, and many more

Spotty (Python, JSON, Git)

- Developed a program capable of retrieving users' Spotify playlists and subsequently downloading and storing them within a selected directory
- Facilitated users to download beyond the Spotify API's imposed 100-song limit, seamlessly integrating all tracks into a designated location
- Implemented OOP practices utilizing various classes with their own distinct functionalities lending itself to easy customization

Rainmaker Irrigation (HTML, CSS, Javascript, PostgreSQL, Express.js, Git)

- Conceptualized and developed a website for an independent irrigation company specializing in freelancing services
- Employed HTML, CSS, and Javascript to craft engaging website components and capture user inputs and for appointment booking
- Designed a seamless REST API, facilitating smooth integration of customer data into PostgreSQL for versatile owner manipulation

EXPERIENCE

Project Destined

Commercial Real Estate Intern

Falls Church, VA

Jan 2023 - June 2023

- Prepared and presented an investment memo to real estate professionals from Brookfield, Tishman Speyer, CBRE, and other real estate firms
- Received 60+ hours of training on real estate fundamentals, property valuation, deal financing, financial modeling, and market research
- Worked with institutions to build 10-year cash flow projections and sensitivity analysis based on growth rates, hold periods, and exit cap rate

McDonalds

Crew Trainer

Salisbury, MD

September 2021 – June 2023

- Cultivated leadership while aiding the store's rise from 23rd on average to 2nd on the Eastern Shore, cutting delivery time by 3 minutes
- Trained new hires and managed complaints increasing customer satisfaction by 25% during my tenure

LEADERSHIP AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Management Leadership for Tomorrow

Career Prep Fellow

January 2024 – Present

- Accepted into a selective 18-month professional development program for high-achieving diverse talent
- Completed business case studies and assignments to grow leadership and technical skills
- Attended conferences hosted by industry leaders such as Deloitte, LinkedIn, and Target

CODEPATH x Amazon Advanced Training Program

Intern

May 2023 - August 2023

- Acquired proficiency in Python and Java through exercises and creating algorithms for real world use
- Received guidance and mentorship from current Amazon software engineers contributing to my love for computer science